EXPOSITORY WRITING

Faculty of English

General Education Program

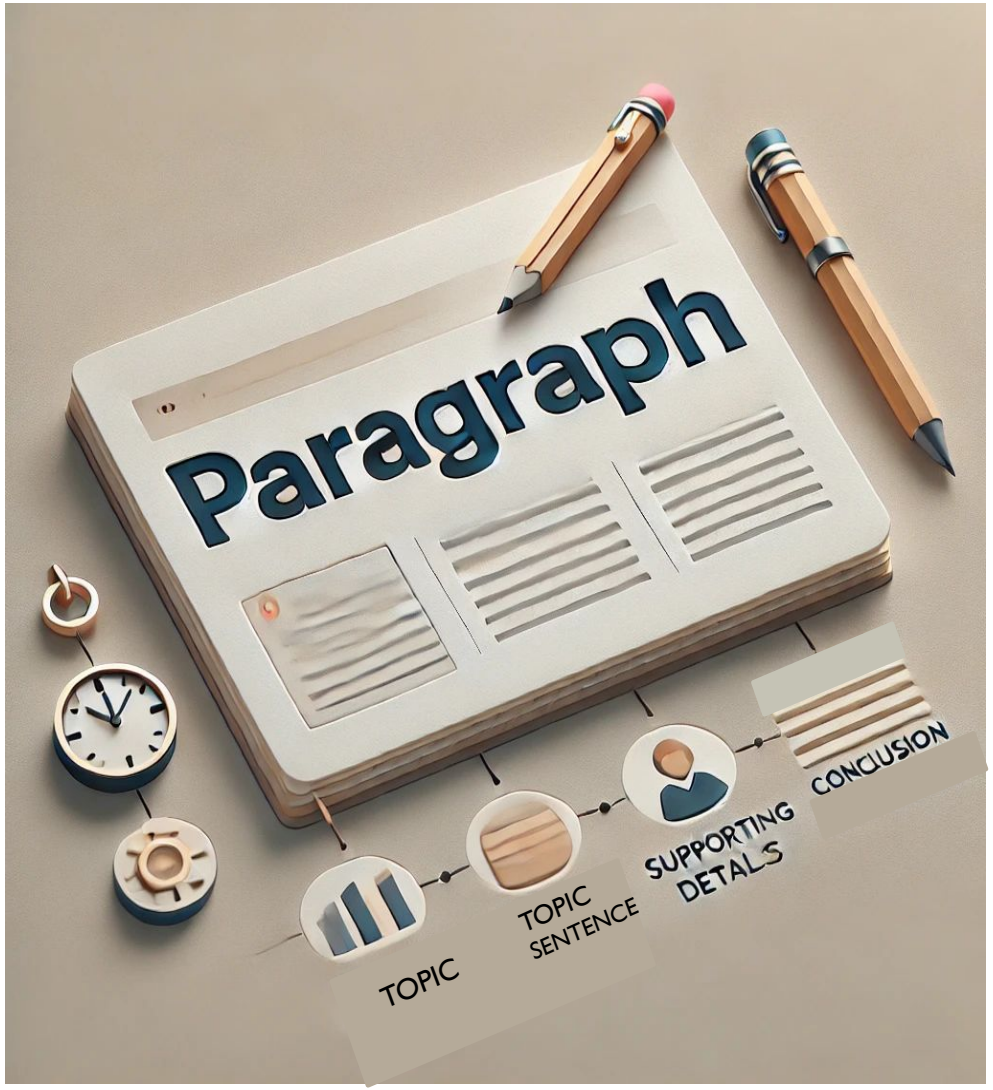
Dow Institute of Health Professionals Education (DIHPE)

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PARAGRAPH WRITING

Structure of a Paragraph



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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- Define the concept of a paragraph and its purpose in writing.
- Identify the structure of a paragraph.
- Develop focused topic sentences.
- Incorporate effective supporting details.
- Write strong concluding sentences.

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WHAT IS A PARAGRAPH

- A paragraph is a group of related sentences that support one main idea.
- Paragraphs break down information into smaller, focused sections, making it easier for the reader to understand and process complex ideas step by step.

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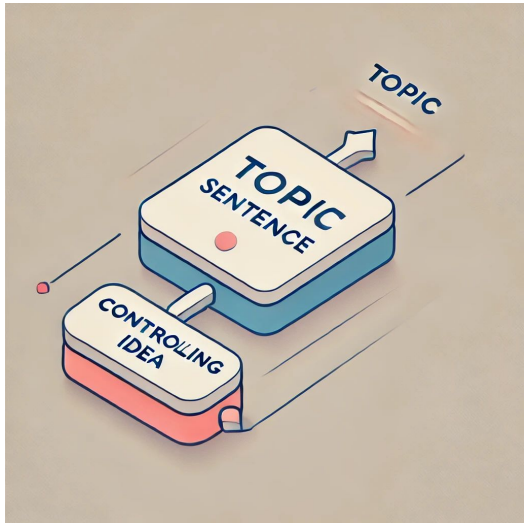
PARAGRAPH STRUCTURE

In general, paragraphs consist of three parts:

1. **Topic Sentence:** Introduces the main idea of the paragraph.
2. **Supporting Sentences:** Provide details, evidence, or explanations that back up the main idea.
3. **Concluding Sentence:** Reinforces the main idea and wraps up the paragraph.

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PARTS OF A TOPIC SENTENCE



A topic sentence typically has two main parts:

1. **Topic:** The main theme or the general idea of the paragraph.
2. **Controlling Idea:** The specific angle, opinion, or direction the paragraph will take.

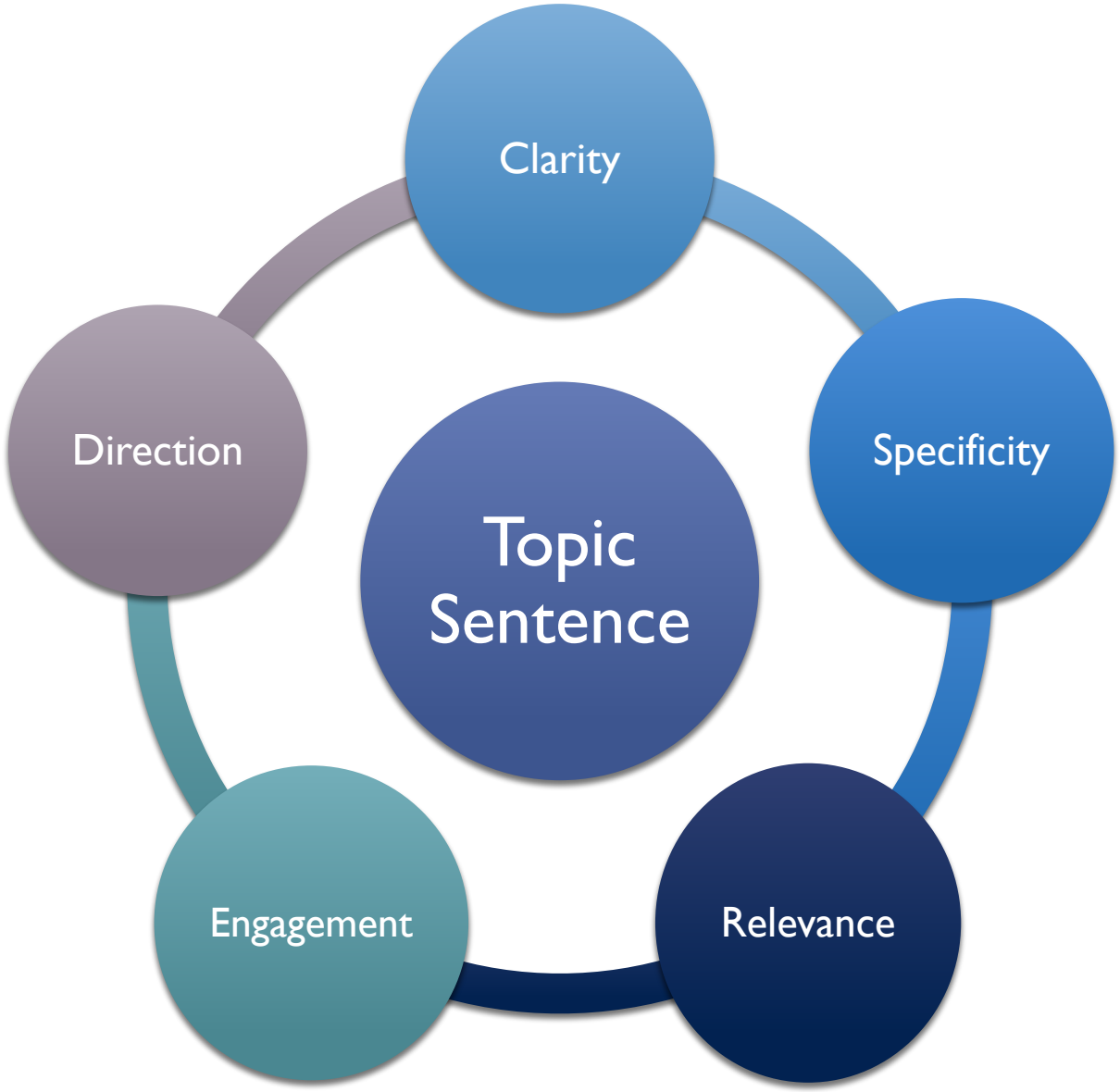
Examples:

- Periodontal disease **causes irreversible bone loss.**
  Topic Controlling Idea
- Dental caries **is a multifactorial disease.**

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QUALITIES OF A STRONG TOPIC SENTENCE

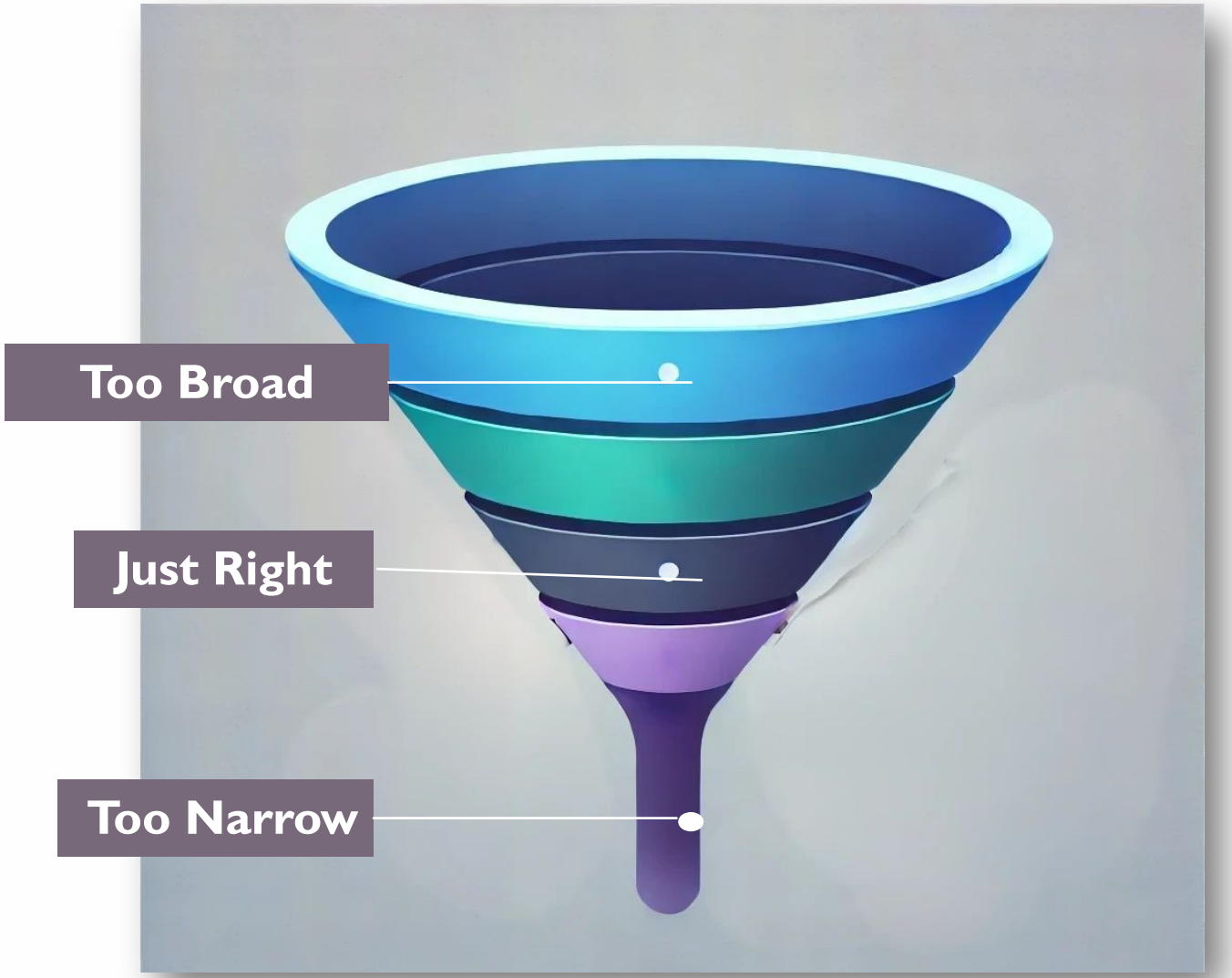


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UNDERSTANDING SPECIFICITY

Your topic sentence shouldn't be too broad or narrow.



License.

TOPIC SENTENCES THAT ARE TOO BROAD

TOO BROAD:

There are many treatments for root canal problems in dentistry.

REVISED:

Root canal treatment **relies on precise mechanical debridement and chemical irrigation to eliminate intracanal infection.**

TOO NARROW:

Streptococcus mutans is a bacteria found in the mouth that ferments sugar.

REVISED:

Streptococcus mutans **plays a primary role in dental caries initiation by producing organic acids that demineralize tooth enamel.**

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TYPES OF SUPPORTING DETAILS

- **Facts:** Verified information that strengthens your explanation.

  Example: The Earth's atmosphere is composed of 78% nitrogen, 21% oxygen, and 1% other gases.

- **Definitions:** Clarify unfamiliar terms or concepts.

  Example: Photosynthesis is the process by which plants convert sunlight into chemical energy.

- **Examples**: Real-world or hypothetical scenarios that illustrate the point.

  Example: For instance, Tesla's electric vehicles run entirely on batteries rather than gasoline.

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TYPES OF SUPPORTING DETAILS

- **Statistics**: Quantifiable data that adds authority to your explanation.

  Example: A recent study showed that 60% of consumers prefer sustainable products.

- **Quotations**: Statements from experts that add credibility.

  Example: As climate scientist Dr. James Hansen stated, 'The key to solving climate change is the rapid transition to renewable energy.'

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HOW TO INCLUDE SUPPORTING DETAILS

- **Ensure Relevance**: Every supporting detail should directly tie back to your main idea.
- **Use a Variety of Supporting Details**: Combine facts, examples, statistics, and quotations to establish your main idea.
- **Use Specific Details**: Avoid generalities—specific facts and examples make your writing more credible and persuasive.

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EXAMPLE OF A PARAGRAPH WITH SUPPORTING DETAILS

- **Topic Sentence**: Regular exercise improves mental health.
- **Supporting Detail 1 (Fact):** According to the Mayo Clinic, exercise reduces levels of the body's stress hormones, such as adrenaline and cortisol.
- **Supporting Detail 2 (Statistic)**: A study by Harvard Health found that 30 minutes of exercise, five times a week, reduces symptoms of depression by 47%.
- **Supporting Detail 3 (Example)**: For instance, a person who incorporates exercise into their daily routine may experience reduced anxiety and improved sleep patterns.

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EXAMPLE OF A PARAGRAPH WITH SUPPORTING DETAILS

- **Topic Sentence:** Periodontal disease **negatively impacts systemic health beyond the oral cavity.**

- **Supporting Detail 1 (Fact):** Periodontal pathogens like *Porphyromonas gingivalis* enter the bloodstream through ulcerated pocket epithelium, triggering systemic inflammation.
- **Supporting Detail 2 (Statistic)**: Studies show that patients with severe periodontitis have a **2 to 3 times higher risk** of developing cardiovascular disease compared to those with healthy gums.
- **Supporting Detail 3 (Example)**: For instance, a patient with poorly controlled type 2 diabetes who undergoes effective periodontal therapy often shows improved glycemic control and reduced HbA1c levels.

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QUALITIES OF A CONCLUDING SENTENCE

- Summarizes the main point
- Restates the Topic
- Bridges to the next paragraph
- Provides closure

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EXAMPLE OF A STRONG CONCLUDING SENTENCE

- **Topic Sentence**: Periodontal disease negatively impacts systemic health beyond the oral cavity.

- **Supporting Details**: Bacterial translocation: P. gingivalis enters the bloodstream via the pocket epithelium, driving systemic inflammation. Cardiovascular link: Severe periodontitis increases heart disease risk 2 to 3 times. Metabolic impact: Periodontal treatment improves glycemic control and lowers HbA1c in patients with type 2 diabetes.

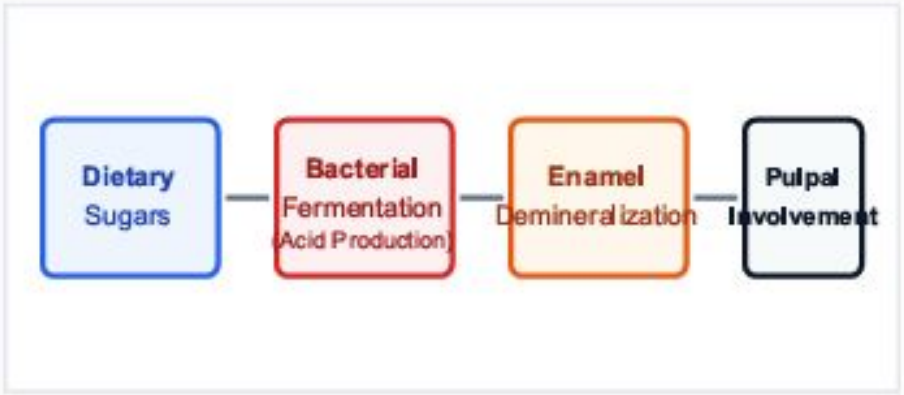
- **Concluding Sentence**: Ultimately, treating periodontal infections is vital not only for maintaining oral health, but also for reducing inflammatory risks throughout the entire body.

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TASK 1: CAUSE & EFFECT PARAGRAPH

Etiology Analysis

Prompt: Examine the diagnostic flow chart below illustrating the pathogenesis of dental caries. Write a cohesive **Cause and Effect paragraph** (approx. 70–90 words) explaining how dietary habits lead to pulpal necrosis. Use appropriate transition words (e.g., *consequently, leads to, as a result, due to*).



Key Stages to Include:

- Substrate: High fermentable carbohydrate intake
- Microbial activity: *Streptococcus mutans* metabolism → lactic acid production
- Tissue response: Drop in pH below 5.5 → enamel hydroxyapatite breakdown
- End Result: Dentinal invasion & subsequent inflammatory pulpal response

Target Vocabulary: demineralization • substrate • acidogenic • lesion progression • as a result • ultimately leading to

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TASK 2: PROCESS ANALYSIS PARAGRAPH

Procedural Writing

Prompt: Review the step-by-step clinical sequence for Endodontic Therapy (Root Canal Treatment) shown in the pictorial icons. Write a chronological **Process Analysis paragraph** instructing a junior intern on how the procedure is executed. Use sequence markers (e.g., *initially, following irrigation, subsequently, finally*).



Clinical Guidelines:

- Isolation: Rubber dam placement prior to cavity entry
- Extirpation: Removal of infected necrotic pulp tissue using endodontic files
- Irrigation: Chemical debridement with Sodium Hypochlorite (NaOCl)
- Obturation: Hermetic sealing of canal space using Gutta-Percha

Sequence Connectors: to begin with • prior to • concurrently • once canal shaping is complete • subsequently • conclusively

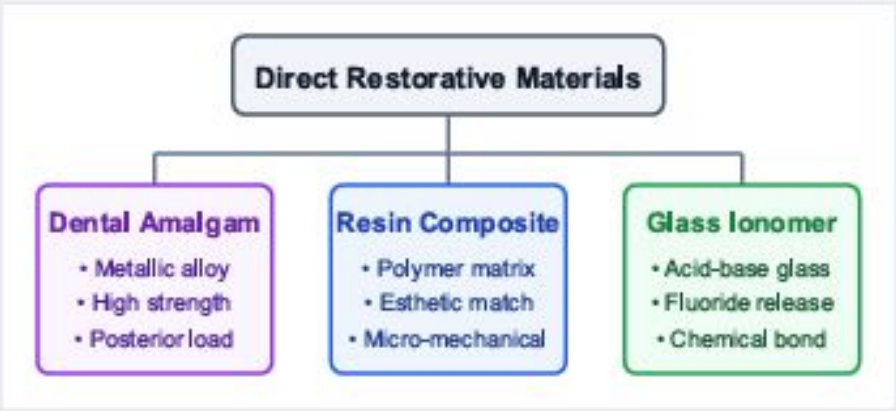
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TASK 3: CLASSIFICATION PARAGRAPH

Taxonomy & Categorization

Prompt: Based on the structural chart below regarding Direct Restorative Dental Materials, compose a well-structured **Classification paragraph**. Categorize the materials based on their chemical composition and primary clinical indications. Emphasize transition phrases of classification (e.g., *can be categorized into, are divided based on, the primary class consists of*).



Key Criteria for Paragraph:

- Identify the main basis of classification (composition & adhesion)
- Group 1: Amalgams (mechanical retention, high compressive stress)
- Group 2: Composites (esthetic, resin-based, polymerizing)
- Group 3: GIC (ion-releasing, self-adhesive, anti-cariogenic)

Classification Phrases: comprise three main categories • distinguished by • further subdivided into • serve primary roles in

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Sample Answers

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TASK 1: CAUSE & EFFECT MODEL SOLUTION (ETIOLOGY)

SAMPLE BENCHMARK PARAGRAPH:

Dental caries progresses through a specific pathological chain of events initiated by dietary habits. **When a patient frequently consumes** dietary sugars, fermentable carbohydrates accumulate as a **substrate** within plaque biofilms. **Consequently,** acidogenic oral bacteria such as *Streptococcus mutans* metabolize these sugars, resulting in rapid lactic acid production. **As a result of** this microenvironmental acid accumulation, the intra-oral pH drops below the critical threshold of 5.5. **This acidity directly causes** enamel hydroxyapatite demineralization. **If untreated, this lesion progression ultimately leads to** dentinal destruction and irreversible pulpal inflammation.

Evaluation Points for Task 1: Check for proper causal link indicators (*consequently, leads to, as a result of*). Ensure student correctly orders cause (sugar/bacteria) prior to effect (acid/demineralization/pulpal exposure).

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TASK 2: PROCESS ANALYSIS MODEL SOLUTION (RCT SEQUENCE)

SAMPLE BENCHMARK PARAGRAPH:

Endodontic therapy relies on a precise, step-by-step clinical protocol to resolve pulpal infection. **To begin with,** the clinician establishes local anesthesia and isolation before creating an access cavity opening into the pulp chamber. **Prior to canal shaping,** working length is measured. **Subsequently,** biomechanical preparation is executed using rotary or manual endodontic files to extirpate necrotic tissue. **Concurrently,** chemical debridement is achieved through continuous irrigation with Sodium Hypochlorite. **Once canal shaping is complete,** the space is thoroughly dried. **Conclusively,** fluid-tight obturation is performed using gutta-percha and sealer to ensure a permanent radicular seal.

Evaluation Points for Task 2: Look for imperative/instructional tone or clear passive clinical reporting. Sequence markers (*prior to, subsequently, once... is complete*) must follow logical clinical workflow.

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TASK 3: CLASSIFICATION MODEL SOLUTION (DIRECT RESTORATIVE MATERIALS)

SAMPLE BENCHMARK PARAGRAPH:

Direct restorative dental materials **comprise three main categories distinguished by** their chemical structure and bonding mechanisms. **The primary class consists of** dental amalgam, a metallic alloy valued for its high compressive strength in stress-bearing posterior teeth. **A second major category includes** resin-based composites, which utilize a polymerizing resin matrix to offer superior esthetics and micro-mechanical adhesion. **Finally, the third class encompasses** glass ionomer cements (GIC). These acid-base glass materials are unique because they form a direct chemical bond to tooth structure while continually releasing fluoride, making them ideal anti-cariogenic restorations.

Evaluation Points for Task 3: Ensure paragraph clearly states the base of classification in the topic sentence. Paragraph must cover all 3 specified categories (Amalgam, Composite, GIC) with distinct comparative features.

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SUMMARY

- A paragraph is a group of related sentences that support one main idea.
- The purpose of a paragraph is to clearly communicate and develop that single idea.
- Each paragraph begins with a topic sentence that states the main idea, followed by supporting details such as facts, examples, and explanations to strengthen the idea.
- The paragraph ends with a concluding sentence, which provides closure and, if necessary, transitions to the next paragraph.

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